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Martin's Funerals

Module 7

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MARTIN'S FUNERALS

REMOVAL PROCEDURE – TO DO MANUAL

(Staff Training & Operational Guide)

1. WHEN THE CALL COMES THROUGH

1.1 Record All Required Information Immediately

Write down clearly and accurately:

- Full name and surname of the caller
- Caller's relationship to the deceased
- Full name and surname of the deceased
- Address where the deceased is located

Ensure handwriting is clear and details are confirmed back to the caller.

2. BEFORE DEPARTURE

2.1 Vehicle & Staff Requirements

Before leaving for the removal, confirm:

- ☐ Martin's official stamp is in the vehicle
- ☐ Removal form is in the vehicle
- ☐ Two staff members are present

⚠ No removal may take place without two staff members.

Professional appearance and calm conduct are mandatory.

3. ON ARRIVAL AT THE RESIDENCE

3.1 First Contact With the Family

DO NOT remove the trolley immediately.

1. Introduce yourself politely and professionally.
2. Express sympathy.
3. Complete and sign the removal form.
4. Answer any questions the family may have.
5. Suggest that funeral arrangements can be made at their home, if appropriate.

Maintain a calm, compassionate, respectful manner at all times.

4. ASSESSING THE SCENE

4.1 Viewing the Deceased

- Ask the family to show you where the deceased is.
- Without unnecessary conversation, observe the layout of the room.
- Plan carefully how you will safely bring in the removal trolley.

4.2 Jewellery Check

- Check whether the deceased is wearing jewellery.
- Ask a responsible family member to remove the jewellery.
- Do NOT handle the body while jewellery is still on.

If jewellery remains on the deceased at the family's insistence, ensure proper documentation and acknowledgement.

5. PREPARING FOR REMOVAL

5.1 Inform the Family

Return to the room where the family is gathered.

- Inform them respectfully that you will now bring in the removal trolley.
- Kindly request that they remain seated until the removal is complete.

This prevents emotional distress and ensures safety.

6. REMOVAL PROCESS

6.1 Bringing in the Trolley

- Move necessary furniture carefully and respectfully.
- Fetch the removal trolley.
- Proceed to the room of the deceased.

6.2 Securing the Deceased

- Gently place the deceased onto the trolley.
- Ensure the body is securely fastened to prevent falling.
- Maintain dignity at all times.

6.3 Room Presentation

- Neatly fold all clothing and bedding.
- Place folded items respectfully on the bed.
- If air freshener is available, spray only once.
- Place a beautiful rose respectfully on the deceased before exiting.

Small gestures matter deeply to grieving families.

7. FINAL MOMENT WITH THE FAMILY

Before removing the deceased from the premises:

- Pause.
- Allow the family time to say their final goodbyes.
- Remain patient, silent, and respectful.

Never rush this moment.

8. DEPARTURE

- Move slowly and respectfully to the vehicle.
- Carefully load the deceased into the vehicle.
- Ensure the body is secure.
- Depart slowly from the property.
- Switch vehicle lights on when leaving.

Professional departure leaves a lasting impression.

QUICK REFERENCE – REMOVAL TO-DO CHECKLIST

Call Details

- ☐ Caller's full name
- ☐ Relationship to deceased
- ☐ Deceased's full name
- ☐ Address

Vehicle Check

- ☐ Martin's stamp
- ☐ Removal form
- ☐ Two staff members present

On Arrival

- ☐ Introduce yourself
- ☐ Complete & sign removal form
- ☐ Answer questions
- ☐ Suggest home arrangements (if appropriate)

Before Removal

- ☐ Assess layout quietly
- ☐ Jewellery removed
- ☐ Inform family before bringing trolley

During Removal

- ☐ Move furniture respectfully
- ☐ Bring in trolley
- ☐ Secure deceased properly
- ☐ Fold bedding/clothing neatly

- ☐ Spray once (if needed)
- ☐ Place rose

Before Leaving

- ☐ Allow time for goodbyes
- ☐ Load carefully
- ☐ Depart slowly
- ☐ Lights on

PROFESSIONAL STANDARD

At every stage:

- Show dignity.
- Show compassion.
- Show patience.
- Speak softly.
- Move slowly.
- Leave the home in better condition than you found it.

You are not only removing a deceased person —

you are serving a grieving family at one of the most vulnerable moments of their lives.

MARTIN'S FUNERALS
STAFF TRAINING MANUAL
MODULE: PROFESSIONAL REMOVAL PROCEDURE

MODULE OVERVIEW

The removal of a deceased person is one of the most sensitive services we provide.

This module ensures that all staff perform removals:

- Legally
- Professionally
- Compassionately
- Safely
- Consistently

SECTION 1: PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS

Every removal must demonstrate:

- Respect for the deceased
- Compassion for the family
- Calm and controlled movements
- Professional appearance
- Clear communication
- Proper documentation

Failure in removal procedure damages trust and reputation.

SECTION 2: CALL INTAKE PROCEDURE

When the removal call comes through, record:

- ☐ Caller's full name
- ☐ Relationship to deceased
- ☐ Deceased's full name
- ☐ Address of removal location

Confirm all details verbally before ending the call.

SECTION 3: PRE-DEPARTURE CHECK

Before leaving:

- ☐ Martin's official stamp in vehicle
- ☐ Removal form in vehicle
- ☐ Two staff members present
- ☒ No removal may take place with only one staff member.

SECTION 4: ARRIVAL PROCEDURE

Upon arrival:

1. Do NOT remove trolley immediately.
2. Introduce yourself politely.
3. Offer condolences.
4. Complete and sign removal form.
5. Answer questions calmly.
6. Suggest arrangements at home if appropriate.

Maintain composure at all times.

SECTION 5: SCENE ASSESSMENT

- ☐ Ask family to show you where deceased is.
- ☐ Observe layout quietly.
- ☐ Plan trolley access route.

Jewellery Procedure:

- ☐ Ask family to remove jewellery.
- ☐ Do not handle body while jewellery remains on.

If jewellery remains → document and obtain acknowledgment.

SECTION 6: REMOVAL PROCESS

Inform family you are bringing in the trolley and ask them to remain seated.

- ☐ Move furniture respectfully
- ☐ Bring in trolley
- ☐ Gently transfer deceased
- ☐ Secure straps properly
- ☐ Fold clothing & bedding neatly
- ☐ Spray air freshener once (if needed)
- ☐ Place rose respectfully

SECTION 7: FINAL FAMILY MOMENT

- ☐ Pause before leaving
 - ☐ Allow goodbyes
 - ☐ Remain silent and respectful
- Never rush this step.

SECTION 8: DEPARTURE

- ☐ Load carefully
- ☐ Secure properly
- ☐ Leave slowly
- ☐ Vehicle lights on

SECTION 9: POST-REMOVAL RESPONSIBILITY

- ☐ Ensure removal form fully completed
- ☐ Submit documentation to office
- ☐ File in MF-file

REMOVAL COMPETENCY ASSESSMENT FORM

Employee Name:

Date of Assessment:

Assessor:

PART A: KNOWLEDGE (Verbal Questions)

Competency	Competent	Needs Improvement
Knows required call information	☐	☐
Understands jewellery procedure	☐	☐
Knows two-staff rule	☐	☐
Understands documentation requirements	☐	☐
Knows professional conduct standards	☐	☐

PART B: PRACTICAL OBSERVATION

Skill Area	Competent	Needs Improvement
Professional introduction to family	☐	☐
Calm communication	☐	☐
Proper completion of removal form	☐	☐
Safe trolley manoeuvring	☐	☐
Secure fastening of deceased	☐	☐
Respectful handling of room items	☐	☐
Appropriate pause for family goodbye	☐	☐
Professional departure	☐	☐

PART C: OVERALL EVALUATION

☐ Competent – Approved for Independent Removal

☐ Further Training Required

☐ Supervised Removals Required

Comments:

Assessor Signature:

Date:

SUPERVISOR SIGN-OFF SHEET

Employee Name:

Position:

Date of Completion of Removal Training:

I confirm that the above employee has:

- ☐ Completed Removal Training Module
- ☐ Demonstrated understanding of procedure
- ☐ Successfully completed competency assessment
- ☐ Been observed during live removal
- ☐ Shown professional conduct and compassion

Authorization:

- ☐ Approved for Independent Removals
- ☐ Approved for Removals With Supervision
- ☐ Not Approved (Further Training Required)

Supervisor Name:

Supervisor Signature:

Date:

TRAINING RECORD ENTRY (For Office Use)

Employee File Updated: ☐

Copy of Assessment Filed: ☐

Copy of Sign-Off Filed: ☐

PROFESSIONAL REMINDER

A removal is not a transport procedure.

It is the first impression of our service.

Families will remember:

- How you spoke
- How you moved
- How you treated their loved one
- How you made them feel

Excellence in removal builds trust for the entire funeral process.

MARTIN'S FUNERALS COMPLETE SERVICE ARRANGEMENT & MF FILE TO DO MANUAL

PART 1: FIRST CONTACT & FILE CONTROL

1. MF-File – Importance & Control

- The MF-file is confidential and must be locked away safely.
- Keep for **minimum 15 years** before destruction (if digital record exists).
- May NOT be altered without written consent from Martin's Funerals Franchising (Pty) Ltd.
- Always write "**N/A**" if a question does not apply.
- Family must sign where required.

2. First Discussion with the Family

Explain clearly:

1. What information and documents you require.
2. That arrangements are done in their presence to meet expectations.
3. That you require:
 - ID of deceased
 - ID of arranging family member
4. The deceased must first be in your mortuary before final pricing (to determine coffin size and service type).

PART 2: REMOVAL OF THE DECEASED

1. Take Removal Instruction

Record clearly:

- Day
- Date
- Time
- Caller's name
- Caller's contact number
- Full physical address
- Clear directions
- Adult / child / oversize
- Cause of death (Natural or Unnatural)

⚠ Only natural deaths may be removed by you.

Unnatural deaths → Government Mortuary.

2. Removal Equipment

Driver must take:

- Toe tag
- MF number
- Elastic
- Gloves
- Clean linen & pillow
- Clean trolley
- Air freshener
- Pen

3. At the Scene

- Complete toe tag fully.
- Relative (16/18+) must sign toe tag.
- Fasten in presence of family.
- Check jewelry and valuables.
- If left on body → record & have family sign.
- Clean the area.
- Open windows.
- Spray air freshener.
- Pray with family.

- Family signs Removal Form before departure.

4. Mortuary Procedure

- Complete Mortuary Book.
- Mark deceased with MF number.
- Disinfect.
- Cover private parts.
- File Removal Instruction in MF-file.

PART 3: ARRANGING THE SERVICE

Step 1: Determine Type of Service

- ☐ Burial
- ☐ Cremation

BURIAL – COMPLETE CHECKLIST

A. Legal Documentation

- ☐ Obtain DHA-1663 from doctor
- ☐ Family signs permission to register death
- ☐ Copy ID of deceased
- ☐ Copy ID of family member

B. Minister & Church

- ☐ Who conducts service?
- ☐ Which church?
- ☐ Member? (Fees may apply)
- ☐ Call Minister
- ☐ Call church office
- ☐ Confirm date & time

C. Coffin Placement

- ☐ In church
- ☐ Remain in car

D. Cemetery Arrangements

- ☐ Which cemetery? (Town/Farm)

If municipal:

- ☐ Sign municipal grave form

If farm:

- ☐ Confirm location
 - ☐ Confirm distance
 - ☐ Provide grave dimensions (2.300 x 0.780)
- Existing grave?
- ☐ Grave number
 - ☐ Tombstone? Headstone or full
- If full stone:
- ☐ Arrange removal
 - ☐ Contact your local tombstone manufacturer

E. Grave Types (Know Before Buying)

- Single
- Double
- Deepened
- Broadened
- Children / Stillborn

- Monument / Memorial
- Garden / Berm
- Existing grave (GO CHECK YOURSELF)

BUY GRAVE 24–48 HOURS BEFORE SERVICE.

Write grave number & receipt number in MF-file.

F. Viewing

☐ Yes / No

Standard:

- 1½ hours before service
- 20 minutes

If another town → adjust timing.

Viewing must preferably be at your facilities.

G. Clothing

☐ Specific clothing requested

☐ Delivered day before service

H. Funeral Notification

☐ Smartphone available?

☐ Permission for SMS?

Call supervisor with details to send SMS.

I. Flowers

☐ Coffin spray

☐ Church arrangement

☐ Loose petals

☐ Loose flowers (number)

☐ Confirm color (NOT type)

J. Programs

Standard: 70

Minimum: 50

☐ Adjust if necessary

☐ Give template to family

☐ Ensure prompt return

K. Additional Items

☐ Bookmarks (close family or all programs)

☐ A4 Photo

☐ A3 Canvas (high quality required)

L. Final Steps

☐ Family details completed

☐ Family signature obtained

☐ Organist arranged

☐ Refreshments arranged

CREMATION – COMPLETE CHECKLIST

A. Legal

☐ DHA-1663

☐ Cremation schedule

☐ ID copies

- ☐ Family permission
- ☐ Complete cremation forms

B. Minister & Church

(Same as burial)

C. Medical Check

- ☐ Pacemaker?
- If yes → remove battery.

D. Cremation Options

- ☐ Cremation before service (urn present)
- ☐ Service only
- ☐ Service with coffin + farewell
- ☐ Cremation after service

E. Viewing

Same procedure as burial.

F. Flowers (Important Differences)

- ☐ Coffin spray (only if coffin present)
- ☐ Loose petals (if farewell at car/wall)
- ☐ Loose flowers (if farewell at car)

G. Programs / Photos / Bookmarks

Same as burial.

H. Finalization

- ☐ Complete file
- ☐ Signature
- ☐ Confirm church organist & refreshments

PART 4: REGISTRATION OF DEATH

Must be registered within 48 hours.

Take DHA-1663 to Home Affairs.

They issue:

- BI-14 (Burial Order)
- BI-20 or BI-5 (Death Certificate)

Death Certificate Handling

- Make certified copies.
- Give original + 5–10 copies to family.
- Keep certified copy in MF-file.
- Family signs for original.
- Do NOT give to unauthorized persons.

PART 5: BI DOCUMENT SUMMARY

DHA-1663 → Medical Certificate

BI-14 → Burial Order

BI-20 → Handwritten Certificate

BI-5 → Computer Printed Certificate

BI-132 → Duplicate application

Attach copies in MF-file.

PART 6: PAYMENT POLICY

METHOD: CASH

Full payment BEFORE service.

Cash Sale → Pink Book

Invoice → Blue Book

No payment = No tent.

PART 7: CEMETERY PROCEDURE

Attach to BI-14:

- Notice of Funeral
- Proof of payment

Confirm:

- New or existing grave
- Depth
- Broadened?
- Tombstone removal?

PART 8: WEEKLY CONTROL

Use Weekly Time Schedule:

- Minimum 3 hours between services
- Avoid double bookings
- Prevent late arrivals

PART 9: FUNERAL INSTRUCTIONS (FOR STAFF)

Complete internal Funeral Instruction Form.

Use color system:

- Full Service – Black
- Half Service – Green
- Delivery – Red
- Trip – Blue
- Tent – Pink

Double-check equipment the day before.

PART 10: SPECIAL REQUESTS

May include:

- Special rituals
- A4 photo on coffin
- Flower placement instructions
- Special needs seating
- Family entry before service
- Flowers moved to hall

Record all in MF-file.

GOLDEN RULES

- Write N/A when not applicable.
- No removal without proper authority.
- Register death within 48 hours.
- Buy grave before service.
- Family signs for all originals.
- Keep MF-file secure.
- Respect at all times.

STAFF TRAINING HANDBOOK

Martin's Funerals: Service Arrangements, MF-File, Removals & Legal Process

Purpose of this handbook

To train staff to handle removals, file completion, service arrangements (burial/cremation), and legal documentation **consistently, legally, respectfully, and with strong recordkeeping.**

Module 1: Professional Standards & the MF-File

1.1 The MF-file is non-negotiable

- The MF-file contains **confidential information** and must remain **secure and locked away**.
- Keep MF-file and attachments for **15 years** before destroying (only if records exist in a register/computer).
- **Do not alter the MF-file format** without written consent from franchising.
- When something doesn't apply, write **"N/A"** (never leave blanks).

1.2 How to guide the family in the arrangement meeting

You must explain:

1. What you need from them (documents + decisions).
2. You will do most planning **in their presence** to ensure accuracy.
3. You need IDs: **deceased + arranging family member**.
4. The deceased must be in your mortuary before final pricing/service finalisation (coffin size + service needs).

Module 2: Removal of the Deceased

2.1 Taking the removal instruction (accuracy prevents disasters)

Record clearly:

- Day / Date / Time
- Caller name + contact number
- Full address + **clear directions**
- Adult / child / oversize
- Cause of death
 - **Natural:** you may remove
 - **Unnatural: Government Mortuary** only (do not remove)

Rule: Ask questions until you are 100% sure. Repeat details back.

2.2 Driver equipment checklist (must-have)

- Toe tag + elastic
- MF number (file number)
- Gloves
- Clean linen + pillow
- Clean removal trolley
- Air freshener
- Pen

2.3 Procedure at the scene (respect + proof)

- Driver completes toe tag **fully at the scene**
- Toe tag must be **signed by a relative** (older than 16/18) confirming details
- Attach toe tag to toe/finger **in front of family**
- Check for jewelry/valuables:
 - If removed and handed over → record who received it
 - If family insists it stays on → note it + get signature
- Clean up behind you:
 - open windows/curtains
 - air freshener
- Offer a prayer before leaving (where appropriate)
- Family must sign removal form before departure

2.4 Mortuary procedures (identity and dignity)

- Complete Mortuary Book from toe tag details **before** storing

- Disinfect and mark deceased (optional: discreet marker with name + MF number)
- Cover private parts (respect)
- Driver returns completed removal instruction to be filed

Module 3: Arranging a Service (Burial or Cremation)

3.1 First decision: Burial or Cremation

Everything branches from this choice. Confirm it early.

3.2 Burial service: key decisions and why they matter

Legal documentation

- Obtain **DHA-1663** from doctor
- Family signs permission for death registration
- Copy IDs: deceased + family representative

Minister/Church coordination

- Confirm minister/pastor and church
- Confirm membership (fees may apply)
- Call minister for availability
- Call church office for building/hall availability
- Confirm a time that works for family + funeral home + church + minister

Coffin placement

- Coffin inside church OR remains in car (confirm early)

Cemetery arrangements

- Town cemetery or farm burial
 - Municipal: municipal grave form signed
 - Farm: confirm location, distance, and provide grave dimensions (**2.300 x 0.780**) if family digs

Existing grave?

- Confirm grave number
- Tombstone? headstone only vs full stone
 - If full stone, allow time and arrange removal by your local tombstone manufacturer

Viewing (important grief and identification step)

- If requested: schedule viewing
 - **1½ hours before service, 20 minutes**
- If service is in another town: viewing time differs (escalate as per internal instruction)

Clothing

- Confirm clothing preferences
- Clothing must be delivered **the day before** service

Funeral notification (SMS)

- Confirm smartphone + permission
- Send SMS details through supervisor (no extra cost)

Flowers (don't specify type)

- Coffin spray, church arrangement, petals, loose flowers
- Ask for **color only** (do not specify flower type)

Programs & optional items

- Programs: usually 70; **never fewer than 50**
- Bookmarks: close family only or one per program
- A4 photo / A3 canvas (high quality required)

Final steps after arrangements

- Contact church office: organist + refreshments

3.3 Cremation service: what changes

Legal documentation

- DHA-1663 + cremation schedule
- Copies of IDs
- Complete cremation schedule
- Family signs permission to register death

Pacemaker check (critical)

- If pacemaker: battery must be removed before cremation (you do this)

Choose cremation format

1. Cremation before service (urn at church; placed in wall or taken home)
2. Service only (no body/urn)
3. Service with coffin present or in car; farewell at car; cremation later

Viewing / Clothing / SMS / Programs / Bookmarks / Photos

Same rules as burial.

Flowers (rules differ)

- Coffin spray only if coffin is at church
- Petals/loose flowers only if farewell at car/wall
- Color only—never specify flower type

Module 4: Registration of Death (Legal Compliance)

Key rule: Register within 48 hours

Take DHA-1663 to Home Affairs; they issue:

- **BI-14** Burial Order
- **BI-20 or BI-5** Death Certificate

Handling death certificates (confidential, controlled)

- Make certified copies
- Give family original + 5–10 copies
- Keep one certified copy in MF-file
- Family signs for original
- Only release to the person who signed the MF-file (others referred to that person or Home Affairs)

Module 5: Graves & Cemetery Requirements

Grave types you must understand

- Single (standard)
- Double (very big deceased or tragedy; not always allowed—confirm)
- Deepened (two coffins possible; costs more)
- Broadened (oversize/casket; mark BI-14 with measurements)
- Children/Stillborn (separate section—must specify)
- Monument/Memorial
- Garden/Berm
- Existing grave (go check yourself; may require stone removal)

Buying a grave

- Buy grave **24–48 hours before service**
- Record **grave number + receipt number** in MF-file

Module 6: Payment Rules

- Method: **CASH**

- Family may pay over time **only if fully paid before the service**
- Cash sale: Pink book
- Invoice: Blue book
- **No payment = no tent** (still book tent but only confirm setup once paid)

Module 7: Internal Planning & Double-Booking Prevention

Weekly time schedule

- Minimum **3-hour intervals** between services (resources/vehicles/teams)
- Avoid double bookings
- Do not run late

Funeral Instructions form (for staff)

- Completed from MF-file
- Given to driver/assistants **day before**
- Double-check all items before service

Module 8: Special Requests (always write it down)

Examples:

- family entry timing
- moving flowers to hall
- A4 photo on coffin
- wreath placement preferences
- wheelchair access
- priest/ritual requirements

Training sign-off (recommended)

Staff should be assessed on:

- Removal instruction accuracy
- Toe tag completion and signatures
- Viewing scheduling rules
- Burial vs cremation differences
- Document control and certificate handling
- Grave booking rules
- Payment policy communication

CHECKLIST BOOKLET (PRINT-FRIENDLY)

COVER PAGE

Martin's Funerals – Operational Checklists

Removals • MF-file • Burial • Cremation • Legal • Cemetery • Payment

A) MF-FILE CONTROL (EVERY CASE)

- ☐ MF-file opened and number allocated
- ☐ Explain to family what info/documents are needed
- ☐ Explain planning done in their presence
- ☐ Copy ID: deceased
- ☐ Copy ID: arranging family member
- ☐ If not applicable items exist → write N/A
- ☐ File stored securely (confidential)

B) REMOVAL INSTRUCTION (CALL IN)

- ☐ Day / Date / Time recorded
- ☐ Caller name recorded
- ☐ Caller contact number recorded
- ☐ Full address recorded
- ☐ Directions recorded clearly
- ☐ Adult / child / oversize confirmed
- ☐ Cause of death confirmed: Natural / Unnatural
- ☐ If Unnatural → Government Mortuary (NO REMOVAL)
- ☐ Driver dispatched with full kit

C) DRIVER KIT (MUST TAKE)

- ☐ Toe tag
- ☐ Elastic
- ☐ MF number noted
- ☐ Gloves
- ☐ Clean linen + pillow
- ☐ Clean removal trolley
- ☐ Air freshener
- ☐ Pen

D) AT THE SCENE

- ☐ Toe tag completed fully
- ☐ Relative 16/18+ signs toe tag
- ☐ Toe tag attached in front of family
- ☐ Jewelry/valuables checked
- ☐ If removed: handed to responsible person + recorded
- ☐ If left on: note + signature obtained
- ☐ Removal area cleaned
- ☐ Windows/curtains opened
- ☐ Air freshener used
- ☐ Prayer offered (where appropriate)
- ☐ Family signs Removal Form before leaving

E) MORTUARY

- ☐ Mortuary Book completed from toe tag
- ☐ Deceased disinfected
- ☐ Deceased marked (toe tag + MF number)

- ☐ Private parts covered
- ☐ Removal instruction filed in MF-file

F) ARRANGING A SERVICE (START HERE)

- ☐ Burial / Cremation confirmed

BURIAL CHECKLIST

F1) Legal

- ☐ DHA-1663 obtained
- ☐ Family permission to register death signed
- ☐ ID copies: deceased + family rep

F2) Minister & Church

- ☐ Minister/Pastor confirmed
- ☐ Church confirmed
- ☐ Membership confirmed (fees?)
- ☐ Minister called (availability)
- ☐ Church office called (hall/building availability)
- ☐ Date/time confirmed with all parties

F3) Coffin placement

- ☐ Coffin in church
- ☐ OR coffin stays in car

F4) Cemetery

- ☐ Town / Farm confirmed

If town:

- ☐ Municipal grave form signed

If farm:

- ☐ Location confirmed
 - ☐ Distance from Reitz confirmed
 - ☐ Grave dimensions given (2.300 x 0.780) if family digs
- Existing grave?

- ☐ Grave number confirmed
- ☐ Tombstone type confirmed (headstone/full)

If full stone:

- ☐ Removal arranged
- ☐ Contact your local tombstone manufacturer

F5) Viewing

- ☐ Viewing requested? Yes / No

If yes:

- ☐ Scheduled 1½ hours before service
- ☐ 20 minutes
- ☐ If other town → timing adjusted/escalated

F6) Clothing

- ☐ Clothing preferences confirmed
- ☐ Clothes delivered day before

F7) SMS notice

- ☐ Smartphone confirmed
- ☐ Permission confirmed
- ☐ Supervisor called with number + details for SMS

F8) Flowers (color only)

- ☐ Coffin spray
- ☐ Church arrangement
- ☐ Loose petals
- ☐ Loose flowers quantity
- ☐ Color confirmed (no flower type)

F9) Programs

- ☐ Quantity set (standard 70)
- ☐ Minimum 50 respected
- ☐ Template given
- ☐ Template returned ASAP

F10) Extras

- ☐ Bookmarks? qty decided
- ☐ A4 photo?
- ☐ A3 canvas? (quality confirmed)

F11) Final

- ☐ Family details completed in file
- ☐ Family signature obtained
- ☐ Church office: organist arranged
- ☐ Church office: refreshments arranged

CREMATION CHECKLIST**C1) Legal**

- ☐ DHA-1663 obtained
- ☐ Cremation schedule obtained
- ☐ IDs copied (deceased + family rep)
- ☐ Cremation schedule completed
- ☐ Family permission signed

C2) Minister & Church

- ☐ Minister/Pastor confirmed
- ☐ Church confirmed
- ☐ Membership confirmed
- ☐ Minister called (availability)
- ☐ Church office called (availability)
- ☐ Date/time confirmed

C3) Pacemaker

- ☐ Pacemaker? Yes / No
- If yes:
 - ☐ Battery removed before cremation

C4) Cremation option chosen

- ☐ Cremation before service (urn at church)
- ☐ Service only (no body/urn)
- ☐ Service with coffin present/in car + farewell + cremation later

C5) Viewing

- ☐ Viewing requested? Yes / No
- If yes:

- ☐ Scheduled 1½ hours before service
- ☐ 20 minutes
- ☐ If other town → timing adjusted/escalated

C6) Clothing

- ☐ Clothing preferences confirmed
- ☐ Clothes delivered day before

C7) SMS notice

- ☐ Smartphone confirmed
- ☐ Permission confirmed
- ☐ Supervisor called with number + details

C8) Flowers (rules apply)

- ☐ Coffin spray (only if coffin at church)
- ☐ Church arrangement
- ☐ Loose petals (if farewell at car/wall)
- ☐ Loose flowers (if farewell at car)
- ☐ Color confirmed (no flower type)

C9) Programs

- ☐ Quantity set (standard 70)
- ☐ Minimum 50 respected
- ☐ Template given
- ☐ Template returned ASAP

C10) Extras

- ☐ Bookmarks? qty decided
- ☐ A4 photo?
- ☐ A3 canvas? (quality confirmed)

C11) Final

- ☐ Family details completed in file
- ☐ Family signature obtained
- ☐ Church office: organist arranged
- ☐ Church office: refreshments arranged

G) DEATH REGISTRATION & CERTIFICATE CONTROL

- ☐ Death registered within 48 hours
- ☐ BI-14 obtained
- ☐ BI-20 or BI-5 obtained
- ☐ Certified copies made
- ☐ Original + 5–10 copies given to family
- ☐ Family signed for original
- ☐ Certified copy filed in MF-file
- ☐ Certificates only issued to authorized person

H) PAYMENT

- ☐ Payment method explained: CASH
- ☐ Full payment before service confirmed
- ☐ Cash sale recorded (pink book) OR invoice issued (blue book)
- ☐ Tent rule explained: no payment = no tent

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

Staff Training Assessment Quiz

Employee Name: _____

Date: _____

Trainer: _____

Section A: Multiple Choice

1) Within how many hours must a death legally be registered?

- A) 24 hours
- B) 48 hours
- C) 72 hours
- D) 7 days

2) If the cause of death is UNNATURAL, who is allowed to remove the deceased?

- A) Martin's Funerals staff
- B) The family
- C) Government Mortuary only
- D) The hospital nurse

3) What is the purpose of the BI-14?

- A) It is the Death Certificate
- B) It is the cremation schedule
- C) It serves as a burial order and transport permit
- D) It is used to book the church

4) What is the MINIMUM number of funeral programs that should be printed?

- A) 30
- B) 40
- C) 50
- D) 70

Section B: True or False

5) It is acceptable to leave sections in the MF-file blank if they do not apply.

True / False

6) A Death Certificate may be given to any close family member who requests it.

True / False

7) A viewing is preferably done at your facilities before the deceased is taken to the church.

True / False

Section C: Short Answer

8) List FOUR important details that must be recorded when taking a removal instruction call.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

9) What must be done if the deceased had a pacemaker and the family chooses cremation?

10) Name THREE grave types you must understand before reserving or buying a grave.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

ANSWER KEY

1) B – 48 hours

2) C – Government Mortuary only

3) C – It serves as a burial order and transport permit

4) C – 50 (Minimum is 50; standard is 70)

5) False

All non-applicable questions must be marked “N/A”.

6) False

Death Certificates may only be given to the person who signed the MF-file and arranged the funeral (others must be referred to that person or to Home Affairs).

7) True

8) Acceptable answers (any four):

- Day
- Date
- Time
- Name of caller
- Caller contact number
- Full physical address
- Clear directions to the address
- Adult / child / oversize body
- Cause of death

9)

The pacemaker battery must be removed before cremation can take place.

10) Acceptable answers (any three):

- Single grave
- Double grave
- Deepened grave
- Broadened grave
- Children / Stillborn grave
- Monument / Memorial
- Garden / Berm
- Existing grave

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

REPATRIATION & TRANSPORT OF HUMAN REMAINS

TO-DO MANUAL (Training & Operational Use)

This document is formatted to integrate directly into your Staff Training Manual as a dedicated module.

MODULE: INTERNATIONAL REPATRIATION OF HUMAN REMAINS

SECTION 1: OVERVIEW

Repatriation is the international transport of human remains from South Africa to another country.

This process is:

- Highly regulated
- Documentation-driven
- Time sensitive
- Legally controlled
- Often supervised by consulates

Private individuals may NOT arrange export permits themselves.

All permits must be arranged by a registered funeral director.

SECTION 2: STANDARD DOCUMENT PACK (EUROPE)

Below is the standard documentation set required for most European countries.

REQUIRED FROM SOUTH AFRICA

1. Official Death Certificate

- Issued by Department of Home Affairs
- Sometimes required in English
- May require sworn translation

2. Medical Certificate (Cause of Death)

- Issued by treating doctor or hospital
- Post-mortem report may be required in some cases

3. Non-Infectious Disease Certificate

(Also called: Non-Contagious Letter / Non-Infectious Declaration)

Must confirm:

- Death was NOT caused by a contagious or dangerous disease

Issued by:

- Treating doctor
- Hospital

This document is critical for consular approval.

4. Embalming Certificate

Issued by:

- Mortuary

Must confirm:

- Professional embalming
- International standard compliance
- Technical embalming details

Consulates carefully examine embalming specifications.

5. Packaging & Sealing Certificate

Provided by:

- Mortuary / Repatriation company

Must confirm:

- Zinc lining (if required)
- Leak-proof coffin
- Proper sealing
- Safe international transport compliance

6. Export Permit (Human Remains Export Permit)

Obtained from:

- Department of Health (National or Provincial)
- Sometimes State Pathologist / Forensic Services stamp required

Important:

- Applied for by funeral director only
- Not available to private individuals
- Usually processed via repatriation channels

7. Identification & Transport Details

Include:

- Passport or ID of deceased
- Airline
- Flight details
- Airway Bill (AWB)
- Date & route of transport
- Sender contact details
- Receiver contact details

8. Family Consent / Legal Authority

Must include:

- Declaration authorizing repatriation
- Power of attorney (if applicable)
- Contact details of European funeral director
- Name & address of receiving facility
- Confirmation that remains will be legally received in destination country

SECTION 3: REQUIREMENTS IN THE RECEIVING EUROPEAN COUNTRY

Requirements vary slightly (Germany, Netherlands, Italy, France, Spain etc.).

Usually required:

1. Import permit (if applicable)
2. Doctor's certificate (English or local language)
3. Copy of passport
4. Airport arrival arrangements
5. Sworn translations (English or EU language)

Most countries require all documentation in English or official EU language.

SECTION 4: WHERE TO OBTAIN DOCUMENTS

Document	Issued By
Death Certificate	Department of Home Affairs
Non-Infectious Certificate	Treating Doctor / Hospital

Document	Issued By
Embalming Certificate	Mortuary
Export Permit	Department of Health
Import Permit	EU Funeral Director / Embassy
Translations	Sworn Translator

SECTION 5: PRACTICAL STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. SA funeral director obtains Export Permit.
2. Complete embalming & sealing.
3. Compile full document pack.
4. Send document copies to EU funeral director.
5. EU director confirms import permit (or confirms not required).
6. Consular clearance (if applicable).
7. Book cargo flight.
8. Issue Airway Bill (AWB).
9. Confirm airport collection arrangements.
10. Send originals with shipment.

SECTION 6: WHAT THE CONSULATE CHECKS

Consulates focus on:

- ☐ Death legally certified
- ☐ No biological risk
- ☐ Embalming compliant
- ☐ Leak-proof packaging
- ☐ Legal export permit
- ☐ Legal receiver in destination country
- ☐ Proper documentation order

SECTION 7: COUNTRY-SPECIFIC NOTES

DE Germany

- Very strict
- Often requires additional legal declarations
- Strict embalming requirements

FR France

- Frequently requires sworn translations

NL Netherlands

- Efficient but strict on embalming details

IT Italy

- Often requires government authorisation

ES Spain

- Usually simpler
- Must have registered receiving funeral director

SECTION 8: CONSULATE DOCUMENT PACK ORDER

Always present documents in this order:

1. Death certificate
2. Medical certificate
3. Non-infectious letter
4. Embalming certificate

5. Packaging/sealing certificate
6. Export permit
7. ID/passport copies
8. Flight details
9. Family consent
10. Receiving funeral service confirmation

Professional presentation speeds approval.

MODULE: TRANSPORT OF HUMAN ASHES

Ashes are treated differently from full body repatriation.

SECTION 1: PERMITS

In most cases:

- No export permit required
- No import permit required

Ashes are not considered a biological risk.

However, always carry:

- ☐ Death certificate
- ☐ Cremation certificate
- ☐ Declaration confirming ashes identity

SECTION 2: METHODS OF TRANSPORT

Option A: Personal Baggage (Most Common)

Requirements:

- Urn must be non-metallic (X-ray compatible)
- Documents must travel with urn
- Some airlines require notification

Option B: Cargo

- Arranged via funeral director
- Air freight or courier service

Option C: Postal Service

- Allowed in some countries
- Many EU countries prefer air carriage

SECTION 3: EU RECEIVING RULES FOR ASHES

Generally required:

- ☐ Death certificate
- ☐ Cremation certificate

Country variations:

DE Germany

- Strict burial laws
- Often requires German funeral director to receive ashes

FR France

- May require transport declaration

IT Italy / ES Spain

- Usually less strict

- Sometimes prior notification required

REPATRIATION COMPETENCY ASSESSMENT FORM

Employee Name:

Assessment Date:

Assessor:

KNOWLEDGE

Area	Competent	Needs Improvement
Knows required SA documents	☐	☐
Understands export permit process	☐	☐
Understands import permit coordination	☐	☐
Knows embalming requirements	☐	☐
Knows ashes transport rules	☐	☐

PRACTICAL SKILLS

Skill	Competent	Needs Improvement
Correct document pack compilation	☐	☐
Proper document order for consulate	☐	☐
Clear communication with EU funeral director	☐	☐
Accurate flight documentation	☐	☐
Legal compliance awareness	☐	☐

Overall Result:

- ☐ Approved for Repatriation Handling
- ☐ Supervised Only
- ☐ Further Training Required

Assessor Signature: _____

SUPERVISOR SIGN-OFF – REPATRIATION MODULE

Employee Name:

Position:

- ☐ Completed Repatriation Training
- ☐ Demonstrated knowledge of export/import permits
- ☐ Successfully compiled document pack
- ☐ Understood EU country variations
- ☐ Assessed as competent

Approval Status:

- ☐ Approved – May handle repatriations
- ☐ Approved with supervision
- ☐ Not approved

Supervisor Name:

Signature:

Date:

PROFESSIONAL REMINDER

Repatriation errors cause:

- Flight delays
- Consular rejection
- Legal consequences

- International embarrassment
- Severe emotional distress for families

Accuracy is not optional.

Documentation must be perfect.

REPATRIATION QUICK REFERENCE CARD

(For Desk Use / Laminated Office Card)

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

INTERNATIONAL REPATRIATION – QUICK GUIDE

A. FULL BODY REPATRIATION – CORE DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Death Certificate (Home Affairs)
- ☐ Medical Certificate (Cause of Death)
- ☐ Non-Infectious Disease Certificate
- ☐ Embalming Certificate
- ☐ Packaging & Sealing Certificate
- ☐ Export Permit (Dept. of Health)
- ☐ Passport/ID of Deceased
- ☐ Flight Details & Airway Bill
- ☐ Family Consent / Power of Attorney
- ☐ Receiving Funeral Director Confirmation

B. EXPORT PERMIT – IMPORTANT

- ✓ Obtained from Department of Health
- ✓ Funeral director must apply
- ✗ Private individuals cannot apply

C. CONSULATE CHECKS

- ✓ Legal death certification
- ✓ No biological risk
- ✓ Proper embalming
- ✓ Leak-proof packaging
- ✓ Legal export permit
- ✓ Legal receiver in destination country

D. DOCUMENT PACK ORDER (FOR CONSULATE)

1. Death Certificate
2. Medical Certificate
3. Non-Infectious Letter
4. Embalming Certificate
5. Packaging Certificate
6. Export Permit
7. ID/Passport
8. Flight Details
9. Family Consent
10. Receiving Confirmation

E. ASHES TRANSPORT (Simpler Process)

Usually NO export/import permit required.

Required documents:

- ☐ Death Certificate
- ☐ Cremation Certificate
- ☐ Ashes Declaration

Urn must be:

- ✓ Non-metallic (X-ray compatible)

F. COUNTRY NOTES

DE Germany – Very strict

FR France – Sworn translations often required

NL Netherlands – Strict embalming compliance

IT Italy – May require government authorisation

ES Spain – Receiving funeral director required

REMEMBER:

Accuracy prevents delays.

Consulates reject incomplete files.

STAFF TRAINING HANDBOOK

MODULE: REPATRIATION – WHAT TO DO, WHY, & STANDARDS

INTRODUCTION

Repatriation is the international transportation of human remains.

It involves:

- Legal compliance
- Medical certification
- Health authority permits
- Airline coordination
- International cooperation

Errors can result in:

- Flight cancellations
- Consular refusal
- Legal liability
- Severe distress to the family

Accuracy is mandatory.

SECTION 1: WHY DOCUMENTATION MATTERS

Each document serves a purpose:

Document	Why It Is Required
Death Certificate	Confirms legal death registration
Medical Certificate	Confirms cause of death
Non-Infectious Letter	Confirms no public health risk
Embalming Certificate	Confirms international transport compliance
Packaging Certificate	Confirms leak-proof containment
Export Permit	Legal authorization to remove remains from SA
Family Consent	Confirms legal authority to move remains
Receiving Confirmation	Confirms lawful arrival

SECTION 2: PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS

When handling repatriations:

- ✓ Double-check every name spelling
- ✓ Confirm passport numbers carefully
- ✓ Ensure embalming meets international standards
- ✓ Confirm airline cargo regulations
- ✓ Communicate clearly with European funeral director
- ✓ Keep digital and printed copies of everything

Never assume — always verify.

SECTION 3: STEP-BY-STEP PROCESS

1. Confirm family instruction and consent.
2. Ensure body is professionally embalmed.
3. Obtain Non-Infectious Certificate.
4. Apply for Export Permit.
5. Compile complete document pack.
6. Send scanned copies to EU funeral director.
7. Confirm import permit (if required).
8. Book cargo flight.
9. Prepare Airway Bill (AWB).

10. Send originals with shipment.

SECTION 4: EMBALMING STANDARDS

The consulate pays special attention to:

- Proper arterial embalming
- Chemical specifications
- Zinc-lined coffin (if required)
- Leak-proof sealing
- Professional mortuary documentation

Improper embalming can result in refusal.

SECTION 5: TRANSPORT OF HUMAN ASHES

Ashes are not considered a biological risk.

However:

- ✓ Carry death certificate
- ✓ Carry cremation certificate
- ✓ Use X-ray compatible urn

Germany may require funeral director to receive ashes.

SECTION 6: RISK MANAGEMENT

Common mistakes:

- ✗ Missing translation
- ✗ Incorrect spelling
- ✗ Missing export permit
- ✗ Incomplete embalming certificate
- ✗ Flight booked before documentation approved

Always wait for confirmation before booking final cargo space.

SECTION 7: ETHICAL STANDARD

Families entrust us with:

- Their loved one
- International compliance
- Cultural sensitivity
- Religious respect

We must operate at the highest international standard.

REPATRIATION CHECKLIST BOOKLET

(Print-Friendly Operational Checklist)

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

REPATRIATION CHECKLIST

A. FAMILY AUTHORIZATION

- ☐ Family consent obtained
- ☐ Power of attorney (if required)
- ☐ Receiving funeral director confirmed
- ☐ Receiving facility address confirmed

B. SOUTH AFRICAN DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Death Certificate obtained
- ☐ Medical Certificate obtained
- ☐ Non-Infectious Certificate obtained
- ☐ Embalming Certificate obtained
- ☐ Packaging & Sealing Certificate obtained
- ☐ Export Permit obtained

C. IDENTIFICATION & TRANSPORT

- ☐ Passport / ID copy
- ☐ Flight booked
- ☐ Airline confirmed
- ☐ Airway Bill issued
- ☐ Sender contact details
- ☐ Receiver contact details

D. DOCUMENT PACK PREPARATION

- ☐ Documents translated (if required)
- ☐ Documents arranged in correct order
- ☐ Copies scanned & emailed to EU director
- ☐ EU director confirmed import permit (if required)
- ☐ Consular clearance (if applicable)

E. PRE-FLIGHT CONFIRMATION

- ☐ Export permit attached
- ☐ Original documents included
- ☐ Receiving airport arrangements confirmed
- ☐ Collection time confirmed

F. ASHES CHECKLIST

- ☐ Death Certificate
- ☐ Cremation Certificate
- ☐ Ashes Declaration
- ☐ Urn X-ray compatible
- ☐ Airline notified (if required)

FINAL SIGN-OFF

Handled By:

Supervisor Check: ☐

Date:

PROFESSIONAL REMINDER

If one document is missing,
the body does not fly.
Documentation first.
Flight second.

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

EXHUMATION PROCEDURE TO DO MANUAL

(Training Handbook + Quick Reference + Checklist Booklet)

EXHUMATION QUICK REFERENCE CARD

(Laminated Desk Version)

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

EXHUMATION – QUICK GUIDE (GAUTENG)

REQUIRED APPROVALS (ALL MUST BE IN WRITING)

- ☐ Gauteng Provincial Government – Forensic Medical Services
- ☐ Department of Co-operative Governance & Traditional Affairs (COGTA)
- ☐ Johannesburg City Parks & Zoo – Medical Officer of Health
- ☐ Landowner OR Local Council
- ☐ Police notification (7 days prior)
- ☒ No exhumation may proceed without ALL approvals.

CORE DOCUMENTS REQUIRED

- ☐ Certified death certificate
- ☐ Certified ID of applicant
- ☐ Minimum 2 certified IDs of close relatives
- ☐ Affidavits (minimum 2 relatives)
- ☐ Undertaker application letter
- ☐ Grave number verification (JCPZ)
- ☐ Reburial approval letter

AFFIDAVIT MUST INCLUDE

- ✓ ID numbers
- ✓ Relationship to deceased
- ✓ Reason for exhumation
- ✓ Burial location
- ✓ Reburial location
- ✓ Date of death
- ✓ Grave number

POLICE REQUIREMENT

- ☐ Apply at nearest Police Station
- ☐ Minimum 7 days before exhumation
- ☐ Police officer must be present

LEGAL BASIS

Removal of Graves and Dead Bodies Ordinance, 1925
(Ordinance 7 of 1925)

REMEMBER:

No written approval = No exhumation.

STAFF TRAINING HANDBOOK

MODULE: EXHUMATION – WHAT TO DO, WHY, & STANDARDS

SECTION 1: OVERVIEW

Exhumation is the legal removal of human remains from a grave for:

- Reburial
- Forensic investigation
- Family relocation
- Legal instruction

Exhumations are highly regulated and sensitive.

Failure to comply may result in:

- Criminal charges
- Permit revocation
- Legal liability
- Reputational damage

SECTION 2: WHY MULTIPLE APPROVALS ARE REQUIRED

Each authority has a specific legal role:

Authority	Purpose
Provincial Health	Public health compliance
COGTA	Provincial governance authority
JCPZ / Municipality	Cemetery control
Landowner	Property rights
Police	Oversight & legal compliance

All approvals must be written.

SECTION 3: AUTHORITIES TO CONTACT

1. Gauteng Provincial Government

Forensic Medical Services

45 Commissioner Street, Johannesburg

Contacts:

Ms. Cynthia Finger – 078 683 4402

Mr. Thokozani Langa – 060 965 8197

2. Department of Co-operative Governance & Traditional Affairs (COGTA)

Nyala Street, Midrand

Contacts:

Ms. Nkhosi

Ms. Tsoku

Mr. Ngomane – 079 874 3680 / 082 855 9541

3. Johannesburg City Parks & Zoo (Medical Officer of Health)

40 De Korte Street, Braamfontein

Contact: Cheryl Greaves – (011) 712 6663

Additional fee payable.

SECTION 4: DOCUMENT REQUIREMENTS

The following are mandatory:

- Certified copy of death certificate
- Certified copy of applicant's ID
- Certified copies of at least 2 close relatives' IDs
- Affidavits (minimum 2)
- Undertaker's application letter

- Grave number verification letter
- Reburial approval letter

SECTION 5: AFFIDAVIT CONTENT REQUIREMENTS

Affidavits must be commissioned and include:

- ✓ ID number of applicant
- ✓ Names of close relatives
- ✓ Residential address & contact number
- ✓ Relationship to deceased
- ✓ Reason for exhumation
- ✓ Burial location
- ✓ Reburial location
- ✓ Date of death
- ✓ Grave number and position

Incomplete affidavits delay approval.

SECTION 6: POLICE REQUIREMENT

- Must apply at nearest Police Station
- Minimum 7 days before exhumation
- Police officer must attend the exhumation

This ensures transparency and legal compliance.

SECTION 7: REBURIAL APPROVAL

Exhumation approval does NOT automatically grant reburial approval.

Separate written permission must be obtained from:

- Landowner (private property), OR
- Local municipality/council

SECTION 8: PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS DURING EXHUMATION

Staff must:

- ✓ Follow health and safety regulations
- ✓ Use protective equipment
- ✓ Treat remains with dignity
- ✓ Maintain privacy and discretion
- ✓ Keep documentation on-site
- ✓ Comply with all authority conditions

SECTION 9: RISK MANAGEMENT

Common mistakes:

- ✗ Missing affidavit information
- ✗ No grave verification letter
- ✗ Police not notified 7 days prior
- ✗ No reburial approval
- ✗ Assuming verbal approval is sufficient

Only written approval is valid.

SECTION 10: ETHICAL RESPONSIBILITY

Exhumations are emotionally intense.

Families expect:

- Sensitivity
- Legal certainty
- Privacy

- Respect

Professionalism is critical.

EXHUMATION CHECKLIST BOOKLET

(Print-Friendly Operational Use)

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

EXHUMATION CHECKLIST – GAUTENG

A. PROVINCIAL HEALTH APPROVAL

- ☐ Application submitted
- ☐ Written approval received

B. COGTA APPROVAL

- ☐ Application submitted
- ☐ Written approval received

C. JCPZ / MEDICAL OFFICER OF HEALTH

- ☐ Application submitted
- ☐ Written approval received
- ☐ Additional fee paid

D. LANDOWNER / MUNICIPALITY

- ☐ Written permission obtained
- ☐ Grave booking confirmation letter obtained
- ☐ Grave number verified

E. POLICE

- ☐ Application submitted at Police Station
- ☐ Submitted at least 7 days prior
- ☐ Police officer attendance confirmed

F. DOCUMENT CHECKLIST

- ☐ Certified death certificate
- ☐ Certified applicant ID
- ☐ Certified IDs of minimum 2 relatives
- ☐ Affidavits (minimum 2)
- ☐ Undertaker application letter
- ☐ Grave verification letter
- ☐ Reburial approval letter

G. AFFIDAVIT VERIFICATION

- ☐ ID numbers included
- ☐ Relationship stated
- ☐ Reason for exhumation stated
- ☐ Burial location stated
- ☐ Reburial location stated
- ☐ Date of death included
- ☐ Grave number included

H. LEGAL COMPLIANCE

- ☐ All approvals in writing
- ☐ Ordinance 7 of 1925 compliance confirmed
- ☐ All authority conditions reviewed

FINAL SIGN-OFF

Handled By:

Supervisor Check: ☐

Date:

PROFESSIONAL REMINDER

Exhumation without full approval is illegal.

Documentation first.

Exhumation second.

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

EXHUMATION RISK & LIABILITY POLICY

1. PURPOSE

This policy establishes the legal, operational, and risk management framework governing all exhumations conducted by Martin's Funerals within South Africa, specifically in compliance with:

- Removal of Graves and Dead Bodies Ordinance, 1925 (Ordinance 7 of 1925)
- Provincial Health regulations
- Municipal cemetery regulations
- Department of Co-operative Governance and Traditional Affairs requirements
- Police oversight requirements

The objective is to:

- Prevent unlawful exhumations
- Protect the company from civil or criminal liability
- Ensure public health compliance
- Maintain professional and ethical standards

2. SCOPE

This policy applies to:

- Directors
- Funeral practitioners
- Operational managers
- Removal teams
- Administrative staff
- Any contractor involved in exhumation activities

3. LEGAL COMPLIANCE REQUIREMENT

No exhumation may take place unless:

1. Written approval is obtained from all required authorities.
2. Police have been formally notified at least 7 days prior.
3. All required affidavits and documentation have been verified.
4. Reburial permission has been secured separately.
5. All authority-imposed conditions are reviewed and accepted in writing.

Verbal approval is not valid.

4. LIABILITY RISKS

Failure to comply may result in:

4.1 Criminal Liability

- Unlawful disturbance of human remains
- Public health violations
- Breach of municipal regulations

4.2 Civil Liability

- Claims by family members
- Emotional distress claims
- Cemetery damage claims
- Landowner claims

4.3 Regulatory Liability

- Permit suspension
- Franchise disciplinary action
- Government sanctions

5. DOCUMENT CONTROL POLICY

Before exhumation, the responsible manager must confirm:

- ☐ All approvals are in writing
- ☐ Certified copies of required documents are on file
- ☐ Affidavits meet legal requirements
- ☐ Grave number verified
- ☐ Reburial site legally approved

A "Pre-Exhumation Authorization Form" must be signed by management.
No signed authorization = no exhumation.

6. POLICE REQUIREMENT

- Application must be made 7 days prior.
- Police presence must be confirmed in writing.
- Exhumation must not proceed without law enforcement attendance.

7. LAND & PROPERTY LIABILITY

If the grave is on private land:

- Written landowner consent required.
- Any land damage must be restored.
- Indemnity clauses may be required.

Municipal cemeteries require official grave verification.

8. PROFESSIONAL LIABILITY INSURANCE

The company must ensure:

- Public liability insurance is active.
- Policy covers exhumation activity.
- Coverage includes worker injury and third-party claims.

9. ETHICAL OBLIGATION

Exhumations must be:

- Conducted discreetly.
- Conducted respectfully.
- Shielded from public view where possible.
- Handled with dignity at all times.

10. POLICY ENFORCEMENT

Any staff member who:

- Conducts an exhumation without full approval
- Falsifies documentation
- Fails to notify police

May face:

- Immediate suspension
- Internal disciplinary action
- Reporting to regulatory authorities

MARTIN'S FUNERALS

HEALTH & SAFETY PROCEDURE FOR EXHUMATIONS

1. PURPOSE

To protect:

- Staff
- Public
- Family members
- Environment

During exhumation activities.

2. RISK ASSESSMENT REQUIREMENT

Before each exhumation, a risk assessment must be completed addressing:

- ☐ Ground stability
- ☐ Depth of grave
- ☐ Condition of coffin
- ☐ Environmental hazards
- ☐ Biological exposure risk
- ☐ Weather conditions
- ☐ Public access control

3. PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT (PPE)

Mandatory PPE:

- Protective gloves (double-layer recommended)
- Waterproof overalls
- Safety boots (steel toe)
- Face mask / respirator
- Eye protection
- Disposable aprons
- Hand sanitizer

No PPE = no exhumation.

4. BIOLOGICAL RISK CONTROL

Even if death was not infectious:

- Assume potential biological hazard.
- Avoid direct skin contact.
- Avoid splashing or aerosolization.
- Disinfect equipment after use.
- Dispose of contaminated materials safely.

5. SITE SAFETY CONTROL

- Secure perimeter with barriers.
- Restrict public access.
- Control media presence.
- Maintain dignity screen if necessary.

6. EXCAVATION PROCEDURE

- Use professional excavation methods.
- Avoid collapsing soil.
- Support grave walls if necessary.
- Avoid damaging adjacent graves.

Mechanical equipment must be operated by trained personnel only.

7. HANDLING OF REMAINS

- Treat remains respectfully.
- Minimize disturbance.
- Use body bags where necessary.
- Maintain identification at all times.

8. TRANSPORT SAFETY

- Use properly prepared vehicle.
- Ensure remains are secured.
- Avoid public exposure.

9. DISINFECTION PROCEDURE

After exhumation:

- ☐ Clean all equipment
- ☐ Disinfect tools
- ☐ Dispose of contaminated PPE
- ☐ Sanitize vehicle
- ☐ Wash hands thoroughly

10. INCIDENT REPORTING

If any of the following occurs:

- Injury
- Biological exposure
- Grave collapse
- Public complaint
- Police dispute

An Incident Report must be completed immediately.

11. WEATHER CONDITIONS

Exhumation must not proceed if:

- Heavy rainfall causes soil instability
- Flooding occurs
- Safety risk increases

Safety overrides scheduling.

12. STAFF TRAINING REQUIREMENT

Only trained personnel may conduct exhumations.

Training must include:

- Legal compliance
- PPE use
- Biohazard handling
- Dignity protocols
- Documentation control

MANAGEMENT SIGN-OFF

Policy Approved By:

Title:

Date:

Health & Safety Officer:

Signature:

FINAL PRINCIPLE

Exhumation is one of the highest-risk procedures in funeral operations.

If there is any doubt:

STOP.

Verify documentation.

Verify safety.

Then proceed.

MARTIN'S FUNERALS
PRE-EXHUMATION AUTHORIZATION FORM

SECTION 1: CASE DETAILS

Case Reference Number: _____
 MF File Number: _____
 Date of Application: _____
 Name of Deceased: _____
 ID / Passport Number: _____
 Date of Death: _____
 Grave Number: _____
 Cemetery / Location: _____

SECTION 2: PURPOSE OF EXHUMATION

- ☐ Reburial
☐ Relocation to family plot
☐ Forensic investigation
☐ Court order
☐ Other (specify): _____

SECTION 3: AUTHORITY APPROVAL VERIFICATION

All approvals must be attached in writing before authorization is granted.

Authority	Written Approval Attached	Date Received
Gauteng Provincial Health (Forensic Medical Services)	☐ Yes	_____
COGTA (Office of the Minister)	☐ Yes	_____
Johannesburg City Parks & Zoo	☐ Yes	_____
Landowner / Municipality	☐ Yes	_____
Police Notification (7 days prior)	☐ Yes	_____

SECTION 4: DOCUMENT CHECKLIST

- ☐ Certified death certificate
☐ Certified applicant ID
☐ Certified IDs of minimum 2 close relatives
☐ Affidavits (minimum 2)
☐ Undertaker application letter
☐ Grave verification letter
☐ Reburial approval letter

SECTION 5: HEALTH & SAFETY CONFIRMATION

- ☐ Risk Assessment completed
☐ PPE available and inspected
☐ Biohazard controls confirmed
☐ Site access plan in place
☐ Weather conditions acceptable

SECTION 6: MANAGEMENT AUTHORIZATION

I confirm that:

- All required approvals have been obtained.
- All documentation has been verified.
- Health & safety measures are in place.
- Legal compliance has been reviewed.

Authorized By (Manager): _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Exhumation Date Approved For: _____

MARTIN'S FUNERALS
SITE RISK ASSESSMENT TEMPLATE – EXHUMATION

SECTION 1: SITE DETAILS

Location:

Cemetery / Property Owner:

Date of Assessment:

Assessed By:

SECTION 2: ENVIRONMENTAL RISKS

Risk Factor	Low	Medium	High	Notes
Soil Stability	☐	☐	☐	
Grave Depth	☐	☐	☐	
Adjacent Graves Risk	☐	☐	☐	
Water / Flood Risk	☐	☐	☐	
Weather Conditions	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION 3: BIOLOGICAL & HEALTH RISKS

Risk	Yes	No	Controls in Place
Potential Infectious Remains	☐	☐	
Coffin Deterioration	☐	☐	
Odour / Exposure Risk	☐	☐	
Public Health Exposure	☐	☐	

SECTION 4: OPERATIONAL RISKS

- ☐ Excavation equipment inspected
- ☐ Perimeter secured
- ☐ Police attendance confirmed
- ☐ Dignity screens available
- ☐ Emergency contact numbers available

SECTION 5: PPE CONFIRMATION

- ☐ Gloves
- ☐ Waterproof overalls
- ☐ Safety boots
- ☐ Face mask / respirator
- ☐ Eye protection
- ☐ Sanitizer

SECTION 6: RISK DECISION

- ☐ Safe to proceed
- ☐ Proceed with additional controls
- ☐ Unsafe – postpone

Assessor Signature:

Date:

MARTIN'S FUNERALS
PUBLIC LIABILITY WAIVER & INDEMNITY FORM
(For Exhumation Activities)

This agreement is entered into between:

Martin's Funerals (Pty) Ltd

and

Applicant Name:

ID Number:

1. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I acknowledge that:

- Exhumation involves inherent risks.
- The process is regulated by law.
- All approvals have been obtained.

2. INDEMNITY

I hereby indemnify and hold harmless Martin's Funerals, its franchisor, affiliated entities, directors, shareholders, officers, employees, agents, contractors, and representatives from and against any and all, and contractors against:

- Claims arising from family disputes
- Emotional distress claims
- Property damage claims not caused by negligence
- Delays caused by government authorities
- Actions required by regulatory authorities

This indemnity does not exclude liability arising from gross negligence.

3. CONFIRMATION OF AUTHORITY

I confirm that:

- I am legally authorized to request the exhumation.
- All close relatives have been informed.
- All information provided is true and correct.

Applicant Signature: _____

Date: _____

Witness Name: _____

Witness Signature: _____

MARTIN'S FUNERALS
DIGNITY & PRIVACY PROTOCOL
(Exhumation Operations)

1. PURPOSE

To ensure that all exhumations are conducted with:

- Respect
- Cultural sensitivity
- Confidentiality
- Privacy

2. PUBLIC VIEW CONTROL

- Establish perimeter barriers.
- Use dignity screens where necessary.
- Restrict media access.
- Limit public observation.

3. FAMILY COMMUNICATION

- Brief family before exhumation.
- Explain process clearly.
- Offer private viewing opportunity (if appropriate).
- Maintain compassionate communication.

4. REMAINS HANDLING

- Avoid unnecessary exposure.
- Use appropriate body bags.
- Maintain identification throughout.
- Handle remains with dignity at all times.

5. MEDIA & SOCIAL MEDIA POLICY

- No staff may take photographs.
- No information may be shared publicly.
- All media inquiries must be directed to management.

6. CULTURAL & RELIGIOUS RESPECT

- Confirm religious requirements beforehand.
- Respect rituals where legally permissible.
- Consult family before final handling.

7. CONFIDENTIALITY

All documentation and discussions are confidential and must be handled in accordance with company policy and POPIA regulations.

8. STAFF CONDUCT

- Speak softly.
- Move deliberately.
- Dress professionally.
- Avoid inappropriate conversation.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

Exhumation is not merely a legal procedure.

It is an emotional and cultural event.

Professionalism, safety, legality, and dignity must operate together at all times.

DAILY PRIORITIES - TO DO MANUAL

PLEASE NOTE:

This manual serves as a guideline and need not be followed rigidly.

Use it to ensure that all daily responsibilities are completed efficiently and professionally.

MONDAY

1. Collect Weekend Equipment

- Assign a driver to collect all stock used at funerals over the weekend (from client homes and graves).
- Check items against the appropriate form in the MF-file.

Items from Client's House:

- Church Trolley
- Coffin stand(s)
- Night Vision Stands
- Night Vision Curtains
- Tent (house)
- Tables (house)
- Chairs (house)
- Plates
- Water glasses

Items from Grave (Driver Responsible):

- Grave tents
- Grave mats
- Grave tables
- Grave tablecloths
- Grave chairs
- Grave mugs
- Grave glasses
- Lowering device
- Ropes
- Planks
- Phone for Pictures
- Files

IMPORTANT:

If anything is missing, the person who signed for it will be held responsible.

2. Stock Verification

- The responsible person must check all returned equipment.
- Ensure EVERYTHING is accounted for.

3. Cleaning

- ALL equipment MUST be cleaned properly.
- ALL vehicles MUST be cleaned thoroughly.

4. Photo

- Prepare a neat, clearly marked Digital photo album.
- Ensure the client receives it as soon as possible.

5. New Weekend Cases

- Fetch family members of bodies brought in over the weekend.
- Begin negotiations and arrangements as far as possible.

TUESDAY & WEDNESDAY

1. Client Consultations

- Discuss different service options and arrangements.
- Tailor services to client needs.

2. Documentation

- Finalize ALL documentation.
- Complete registration of death.
- MARTIN'S FUNERALS must handle this — NOT the client.

3. Graves or cremations

- Book or purchase graves or crematoriums.
- Record details in the appropriate file.
- Ensure receipt numbers are obtained and filed.

4. Stock Control

- Check stock levels.
- Re-order if necessary.
- Prepare for normal and unforeseen needs.

5. Vehicles

- Ensure ALL vehicles are:
 - Roadworthy
 - Licensed
 - Clean

6. Equipment Preparation

- Ensure tents, machines, plates, glasses, curtains, etc. are clean and ready.

7. Coffin & Accessories

- Prepare coffin lists.
- Prepare accessory lists.

8. Coffin Preparation

- Install handles.
- Fit linings and trimmings.
- Or buy a fully trimmed coffin.

9. Body Preparation

Ensure the body is presentable:

- Eyes and mouth closed
- Body cleaned
- Hair combed
- Spectacles fitted (if applicable)
- Clothes properly fitted
- Any additional preparation required for dignity and family acceptance

10. Embalming

- Embalm body if applicable.

11. External Bookings

- Order flowers.
- Order tents.
- Book church.
- Book traffic department. Pay the fee when the funeral procession is far.
- Arrange any additional required services.

THURSDAY

1. Finalize Client Arrangements

- Confirm all arrangements.
- Confirm payments.

2. Documentation Check

- Ensure ALL necessary documents are in the file.

3. Graves or Cremation

- Finalize grave purchase and digging.
- When it is a cremation, get the date when the deceased need to be at the crematorium.

4. Transport & Toilets

- If applicable, check whether client needs assistance with buses or toilets.
- DO NOT become involved in arranging them.

5. Tents

- Finalize erection of tents at client's home.

6. Weekend Programs

- Draw up delivery programs.
- Draw up funeral programs.

7. Driver Briefing

- Ensure drivers know:
 - Their teams
 - Their responsibilities

8. Backup Team

- Arrange backup team at office for weekend.
- Agree on payment beforehand.

9. Distribute Programs

- Provide weekend programs to drivers, assistants, and agents.
- Ensure they FULLY understand expectations.

10. Equipment Check

- Confirm everything needed for funerals is in the correct place.

11. Vehicle Final Inspection

Check ALL vehicles including trailers and "helicopters":

- Licensed
- Roadworthy
- Lights working
- Water
- Petrol
- Oil
- Brake oil
- Transmission oil

12. Tents & Toilets

- Confirm tents and toilets were actually erected.

FRIDAY

1. Final Arrangements Check

- Conduct a personal final inspection of all arrangements.
- BEST if done by you personally.

2. Vehicle Inspection (Again)

Ensure vehicles are ready for “GO”:

- Licensed
- Roadworthy
- Lights
- Water
- Petrol
- Oil
- Brake & transmission oil
- Logbooks
- Overnight goods (long-distance drivers)

3. Body Verification

- Ensure driver takes the CORRECT body.
- Ensure departure time allows for unforeseen delays.

NON-NEGOTIABLE:

THE BODY MUST ALWAYS ARRIVE ON TIME.

4. Vehicle Return

- Ensure driver returns vehicle to depot.

5. Logbook Check

- Inspect logbook upon vehicle return.

SATURDAY & SUNDAY

1. Arrive Early

- Be at the office BEFORE drivers and staff.

2. Staff Presentation

Ensure drivers are:

- On time
- Sober
- Calm
- Neatly dressed

You must be dressed and prepared to step in if necessary.

EVEN TWO MINUTES LATE IS NOT ACCEPTABLE.

3. Spot Check

- Conduct quick inspection of vehicles.

4. Logbooks

- Check latest entries.

5. Team Briefing

- Ensure everyone knows their responsibilities.

6. Representation

- For prominent funerals, consider representing MARTIN’S FUNERALS personally.

7. Time Management

- A large funeral should not exceed 3 hours:

- House/Church Service
- Grave Service
- Delivery of family home

Keep this in mind during planning.

8. Vehicle Inspection on Return

- Inspect for dents and scratches.

9. Logbook Completion

- Ensure ALL logbooks are fully completed.

10. End of Day Responsibility

- Only go home once:
 - All vehicles have returned
 - All staff have returned
 - All matters are calm
 - Someone is available to take calls

FINAL RESPONSIBILITY

It is YOUR responsibility to resolve any problems during the day.

DO NOT leave until you are certain everything is under control.

REMEMBER:

WE PROVIDE A LOVING SERVICE.